Dennis Ritche (standing) and Ken Thomson working on the first computer for which they designed C (The PDP-11).

syntax of the current (4.9) version of GCC. It is commonly referred to as C89 or C90. Since then C has had two major revisions, once in 1999 (known as C99), and again in 2011 (known as C11). The upcoming 5.0 release of GCC will finally adopt the latest C11 edition of C as the default.

Given how old it is, it is a testament to the design of the language, and the skill of its designers, that it is relevant to this day.

Significance

It is hard to overstate the significance of C in the landscape of computing today. Nearly every popular programming language used today, whether it be JavaScript, Java, C#, PHP, Objective-C, or even Python is inspired by conventions set by C.

Compared to languages it inspired though, C is significantly low-level. C improves the readability, maintainability and ease-of-development of code significantly compared to Assembly, and is significantly more portable despite giving developers nearly as much power as Assembly does.

C gives developers low-level access to machine hardware, with minimal abstraction and pointers in C let the developer directly work with raw